

LIBRARY LESSON PLAN

Look Again! Finding Hidden Pictures

Grades 1–2 · Library · 25 minutes

Students develop observation skills through "I Spy" and hidden picture books, connecting careful looking to the library skill of finding information and the life skill of looking carefully before believing what we see.

LESSON TIMING

3 min	10 min	7 min	5 min	2 min
GATHERING & HOOK	INTERACTIVE SEARCH	MINI MUSEUM	PARTNER HUNT	CLOSING

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Students will practice careful observation through hidden picture activities, understand that finding information requires patience and attention, and connect the skill of "looking again" to both library research and real-world critical thinking.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

- **AASL I.B.1:** Learners engage with information through following a process.
- **AASL I.D.4:** Learners select information by seeking a variety of sources.
- **TEKS §110.3 (1) 1A:** Listen actively, ask relevant questions to clarify information.

MATERIALS NEEDED

- *I Spy* or *Look-Alikes* book by Walter Wick / Jean Marzollo
- *Where's Waldo?* book or large poster
- Hidden picture printouts (one per student or pair)
- Mini Museum exhibition artifacts for exploration

RECOMMENDED BOOKS

- *I Spy* series by Jean Marzollo & Walter Wick
- *Look-Alikes Jr.* by Joan Steiner
- *Can You See What I See?* by Walter Wick
- *Where's Waldo?* by Martin Handford

LESSON PLAN · GATHERING & HOOK · 3 MINUTES

Display a large *I Spy* or hidden picture image on screen or hold up the book.

"I have a challenge for you today. I'm going to show you a picture, and I bet you can't find EVERYTHING that's hidden in it — at least not on your first try! Our eyes sometimes miss things."

Show an *I Spy* spread. Ask students to find one easy object, then one harder object.

"Did anyone find the second one right away? Sometimes we have to LOOK AGAIN — more carefully — to find what we're looking for. That's what we're going to practice today!"

READ-ALOUD / INTERACTIVE SEARCH · 10 MINUTES

Round 1: Group search — Read the riddle/clue aloud. Give students 30 seconds to scan silently. Ask: *"Who found it? Can you describe WHERE it is without pointing?"* This builds descriptive vocabulary.

Round 2: Challenge search — Choose a harder page with more objects. *"See if you can find THREE things before I count to 20!"* Discuss strategies: look systematically, start at corners, look for colors.

"Finding hidden pictures is a LOT like finding information in the library. You have to: 1) Know what you're looking for, 2) Look carefully in the right places, and 3) Look AGAIN if you don't find it the first time!"

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION · 7 MINUTES

Transition to the exhibition area or bring artifacts to the group.

"Now I want to show you how people over 100 years ago played 'look again' games — but with a twist! They made pictures that TRICK your eyes."

Show Victorian illusion cards: *"Look at this card. What do you see? Now keep looking… do you see something ELSE?"* Let students discover hidden images. *"These cards taught people an important lesson: sometimes you have to look MORE than once to see the truth!"*

Demonstrate stereoscope: *"This machine makes flat pictures look 3D — like they're popping out! It tricks your eyes into seeing something that isn't really there."*

ACTIVITY: PARTNER HIDDEN PICTURE HUNT · 5 MINUTES

Distribute hidden picture sheets (one per pair or student). Students work to find all hidden objects. When finished, they can trade with another pair. Circulate and ask: *"What strategy are you using?"*

CLOSING: THE "LOOK AGAIN" RULE · 2 MINUTES

"Today we practiced a super important skill: LOOKING AGAIN. This helps us in the library when we're searching for books. And it helps us in life too! If something looks strange or too good to be true, what should we do?" (Students: *"Look again!"*) *"Right! Always remember to LOOK AGAIN before you decide what's true!"*

> ### MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION
>
> **Option 1 — Visit:** Victorian transformation cards required careful observation to reveal hidden images — just like *I Spy* books. This builds the foundational skill of looking carefully before accepting what we see.
>
> **Option 2 — Virtual:** Explore the exhibition online.
>
> minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving

DIFFERENTIATED STUDENT HANDOUTS

GREEN LEVEL
MORE SUPPORT

Find 5 hidden objects with picture clues.

YELLOW LEVEL
GRADE LEVEL

Find 8 objects with word clues only.

RED LEVEL
GO DEEPER

Create your own hidden picture for others to solve.

ASSESSMENT

- **Observation:** Can students use systematic strategies to find hidden objects?
- **Discussion:** Can students articulate why "looking again" is important?
- **Exit question:** *"What's one strategy you use to find hidden pictures?"*

BOOK DISPLAY SUGGESTIONS

Create a **"Look Again!"** display: *I Spy* series, *Where's Waldo?*, *Can You See What I See?*, *Look-Alikes*, *Highlights Hidden Pictures* magazines, optical illusion books.